THE INDIAN ARMY IN 1947

Of the three Army commands, Northern Command was allotted to Pakistan while the Southern and Eastern commands were allotted to the Indian Army. A new command, Delhi and East Punjab Command, was raised on 15 September 1947. There were no corps headquarters still in existence and of the four divisions, three – 1 Armoured Division, 4 Infantry Division and 5 Infantry Division – came to India: 7 Infantry Division went to Pakistan.



The 5 Infantry Division shoulder patch. (Raffaele Ruggeri)

Though the division of infantry regiments was intended to result in a ratio of 15:8.11, when the Sikh and Hindu elements were removed from the Pakistani battalions, the number of infantry battalions assigned to India came to 77, with just 33 going to Pakistan. With the addition of 17 Gorkha battalions retained by India, however, the Indian Army had 94 infantry battalions. Infantry regiments of the Indian Army at the time of partition were: the Punjab Regiment (six battalions); the Madras Regiment (seven battalions); the Indian Grenadiers (four battalions); the Mahratta Light Infantry (six battalions); the Rajputana Rifles (six battalions); the Rajput Regiment (four battalions); the Jat Regiment (five battalions); the Sikh Regiment (five battalions); the Dogra Regiment (four battalions); the Royal